

Human Resources English Participant Workbook

Practice pages for realistic field-specific meetings, pushback, documentation, and role-play preparation

Audience: HR business partners, recruiters, talent managers, people managers, employee-relations staff, learning teams, compensation analysts, and HR-adjacent leaders

Focus: A human-resources English curriculum for hiring, onboarding, performance feedback, employee relations, investigations, benefits, compensation, policy explanation, workplace conflict, and dignity-preserving directness.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

How to Use This Workbook

For each module, read a workplace scenario and complete a bounded dialogue. Choose one of four options, then use the answer key to see why the selected phrase fits the evidence, risk, owner, and next step.

Module 1. Recruiting, Screening, and Candidate Experience

Situation

A hiring manager rejects candidates for not feeling like a fit.

Stakeholder pressure: Use the manager's intuition.

Constraint: Selection criteria, interview evidence, bias risk, and documentation need clarity.

Terms to use

- job requirement
- structured interview
- bias
- candidate experience

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A hiring manager rejects candidates for not feeling like a fit.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Use the manager's intuition.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm job requirement, structured interview, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	onboarding reset plan
B	candidate-debrief guide
C	control
D	disclosure

Module 2. Onboarding and Role Clarity

Situation

A new employee is confused about ownership after two weeks.

Stakeholder pressure: Tell them to be more proactive.

Constraint: Role scope, manager check-ins, training, and success measures may be unclear.

Terms to use

- role clarity
- onboarding
- manager check-in
- success measure

Guided dialogue completion**Situation**

A new employee is confused about ownership after two weeks.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Tell them to be more proactive.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm role clarity, onboarding, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	compensation response
B	policy exception review
C	mediation opening script
D	onboarding reset plan

Module 3. Performance Feedback and Documentation**Situation**

A manager wants to put an employee on a warning after months of vague concerns.

Stakeholder pressure: Issue the warning immediately.

Constraint: The employee may not have received clear expectations, examples, or support.

Terms to use

- performance gap
- documentation
- expectation

- support plan

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A manager wants to put an employee on a warning after months of vague concerns.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Issue the warning immediately.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm performance gap, documentation, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	performance feedback script
B	timeline
C	assumption
D	mitigation

Module 4. Employee Relations and Investigations

Situation

An employee reports harassment by a high performer.

Stakeholder pressure: Resolve it quietly because the accused is important.

Constraint: Investigation process, anti-retaliation, evidence, and confidentiality are critical.

Terms to use

- employee relations
- harassment
- retaliation
- confidentiality

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

An employee reports harassment by a high performer.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Resolve it quietly because the accused is important.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm employee relations, harassment, the owner, and the evidence standard.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	performance feedback script
B	compensation response
C	policy exception review
D	investigation intake summary

Module 5. Compensation, Benefits, and Equity

Situation

An employee says a peer is paid more for the same job.

Stakeholder pressure: Promise an immediate adjustment.

Constraint: Pay bands, job leveling, equity review, budget, and communication process matter.

Terms to use

- pay band
- job level
- equity review
- benefits

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

An employee says a peer is paid more for the same job.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Promise an immediate adjustment.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm pay band, job level, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	owner
B	compensation response
C	evidence

Option	Phrase
D	risk

Module 6. Policy Communication and Compliance

Situation

A manager wants to make an exception to leave policy.

Stakeholder pressure: Approve it because the employee is valued.

Constraint: Consistency, accommodation, legal risk, and manager precedent need review.

Terms to use

- policy
- accommodation
- precedent
- compliance

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A manager wants to make an exception to leave policy.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Approve it because the employee is valued.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm policy, accommodation, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	owner
B	scope
C	timeline
D	policy exception review

Module 7. Conflict Mediation and Manager Coaching

Situation

Two team leads accuse each other of blocking work.

Stakeholder pressure: Move one of them to another team.

Constraint: Shared expectations, facts, behavior, and operating agreements should be tested first.

Terms to use

- mediation
- behavioral example
- operating agreement
- accountability

Guided dialogue completion**Situation**

Two team leads accuse each other of blocking work.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Move one of them to another team.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm mediation, behavioral example, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	control
B	disclosure
C	candidate-debrief guide
D	mediation opening script

Module 8. Restructuring and Sensitive Communication**Situation**

Leadership plans a reorg but wants managers to hint at it early.

Stakeholder pressure: Give employees informal warnings.

Constraint: Timing, confidentiality, legal review, messaging, and dignity are essential.

Terms to use

- restructuring
- position elimination
- severance
- talking points

Guided dialogue completion**Situation**

Leadership plans a reorg but wants managers to hint at it early.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Give employees informal warnings.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm restructuring, position elimination, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	timeline
B	reorg communication checklist
C	owner
D	scope

Answer Key and Rationale

Check each answer after completing the dialogue. The rationale shows why the correct phrase is the strongest fit for the real workplace situation.

Recruiting, Screening, and Candidate Experience

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. candidate-debrief guide	A candidate-debrief guide is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Onboarding and Role Clarity

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. onboarding reset plan	A onboarding reset plan is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Performance Feedback and Documentation

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. performance feedback script	A performance feedback script is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Employee Relations and Investigations

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. investigation intake summary	A investigation intake summary is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Compensation, Benefits, and Equity

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. compensation response	A compensation response is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Policy Communication and Compliance

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. policy exception review	A policy exception review is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Conflict Mediation and Manager Coaching

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. mediation opening script	A mediation opening script is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Restructuring and Sensitive Communication

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. reorg communication checklist	A reorg communication checklist is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.